

What's one thing you want me to include in my letter of recommendation?

I want you to tell them that I tried.

Tell them that I stayed up till 4 AM and only slept for 3 hours as a freshman.

Tell them that I skipped lunch, I let my phone ring and return to black, I haven't seen my sister in days.

Tell them about my shaky voice and teary eyes on graded discussion days. How I planned every word I would say with such precision and by the time I worked up enough courage to say it, the moment passed.

Tell them that requiring physics as a course is inhumane and I'll never need to know exactly how many newtons of friction stop me from rolling down a hill.

Tell them that making friends was hard for me but losing them might've killed me.

Tell them that I was excited until this very frightening girl asked me why I cared so much.

Tell them that I just couldn't cut it on the team and that's why I had to quit.

Tell them that I writhe in envy looking at new freshmen living normal lives.

Tell them that I have a passion for biology but my father thinks there are too many Asians applying for that major already—ones way smarter than me.

Tell them that I bleed green and don't really want to go to their stupid school anyway.

Tell them I didn't know if the due date on the assignments page was the date it was due or the date you should do it and that set me off on the wrong track.

Tell them that I did every practice problem, watched every YouTube tutorial, spent hours and hours working and still failed.

Tell them that on the first day of school, my mother drove around for 15 minutes until I was brave enough to get out of the car.

Please tell them that I tried.